

B.Sc. ECS – I Sem – II
CES – 102 : Yoga Education and Sports

Unit – I Yoga Education

What does yoga mean?

Yoga is a spiritual, mental, and physical practice that originated in ancient India. The term "yoga" comes from the Sanskrit word "yuj", which means "to unite" or "to join." In a broader sense, yoga refers to the union of the individual self with the universal consciousness or the divine.

While yoga has roots in spiritual and philosophical traditions, in modern times, it is often understood as a discipline for physical well-being, stress reduction, and mental clarity. It involves a combination of techniques such as:

1. **Asanas:** Physical postures designed to improve strength, flexibility, and balance.
2. **Pranayama:** Breathing exercises to control the life force (prana) and calm the mind.
3. **Meditation:** Techniques to focus the mind and achieve mental clarity, often leading to a state of mindfulness or inner peace.
4. **Ethical Principles:** A set of moral and ethical guidelines (such as the Yamas and Niyamas in classical yoga) to promote personal growth and harmony with others.

Definitions of yoga:

Patanjali in the 'Yoga Sutra' defines yoga as the control of modifications of the mind (Yoga Chitta Vritti Nirodhah).

Aims And Objectives of Yoga Education :

Aims of Yoga Education:

1. **Promote Physical Health and Fitness:**
 - The primary aim of yoga education is to teach students how to improve their physical health through regular practice of asanas (postures) and pranayama (breathing techniques). It enhances flexibility, strength, posture, and balance.
2. **Enhance Mental Clarity and Focus:**
 - Yoga education aims to equip individuals with techniques like meditation and concentration exercises that help improve mental clarity, reduce stress, and enhance cognitive function.
3. **Encourage Emotional and Psychological Well-being:**
 - Yoga education addresses emotional health by cultivating self-awareness, mindfulness, and emotional regulation.
4. **Develop Spiritual Awareness and Self-Realization:**
 - The aim of yoga education includes guiding individuals toward spiritual growth and self-awareness. It encourages the development of inner peace, connection to a higher self, and a deeper understanding of life.
5. **Promote Ethical and Moral Living:**
 - Yoga education encourages students to follow ethical principles like non-violence (Ahimsa), truthfulness (Satya), and self-discipline (Brahmacharya), which are essential for fostering harmony within oneself and in relationships with others.
6. **Foster a Balanced and Harmonious Lifestyle:**
 - A core aim is to teach students to incorporate the holistic aspects of yoga into daily life, achieving balance between work, rest, and play. This includes adopting a balanced diet, positive thinking, and harmonious relationships.

Objectives of Yoga Education:

- 1. Provide Knowledge of Yoga Techniques:**
 - Teach the various forms of yoga (e.g., Hatha, Vinyasa, Ashtanga) and the correct way to practice asanas, pranayama, and meditation.
- 2. Improve the Physical Fitness of Individuals:**
 - Equip individuals with the tools to improve flexibility, strength, balance, and overall fitness, enabling them to live a healthier life.
- 3. Cultivate Mindfulness and Stress Management Skills:**
 - Yoga education aims to teach practical techniques for managing stress, anxiety, and mental fatigue. Through mindfulness practices, it helps students develop the ability to remain present and focused.
- 4. Foster Self-Awareness and Personal Growth:**
 - One of the key objectives is to help students develop a greater understanding of themselves, their habits, and their desires. Through self-reflection, meditation, and mindfulness, students learn to identify areas of growth and focus on self-improvement.
- 5. Promote Social and Community Engagement:**
 - Yoga education aims to create a sense of community and belonging among practitioners. It fosters mutual respect, understanding, and a spirit of cooperation within yoga classes and beyond.
- 6. Instill the Value of Lifelong Learning:**
 - Yoga education aims to cultivate a commitment to continuous learning. This can involve deepening one's practice over time, exploring advanced techniques, or gaining a broader understanding of yoga philosophy and its applications to daily life.
- 7. Create Opportunities for Teacher Training and Certification:**
 - Another key objective is to prepare students who wish to teach yoga to others, offering comprehensive teacher training programs that provide the necessary skills, knowledge, and certifications to teach yoga professionally.
- 8. Promote Holistic Well-being:**
 - Yoga education aims to promote the overall well-being of individuals, addressing the balance of mind, body, and spirit. It encourages holistic practices that incorporate physical exercise, mental relaxation, and spiritual growth.

Need and importance of yoga :

The **need and importance** of yoga have grown significantly in today's world due to the increasing awareness of physical health, mental well-being, and the search for a more balanced and peaceful life. It is recognized not only as a physical exercise but as a complete system for improving overall health, reducing stress, and fostering spiritual growth.

1. Physical Health and Well-being

- **Improved Flexibility and Strength:** Yoga involves various postures (asanas) that help increase flexibility and strength.
- **Enhanced Posture:** Through the practice of yoga, individuals develop better body awareness, which helps correct poor posture and supports the spine, reducing back and neck pain.
- **Boosted Immune System:** Yoga helps improve circulation, stimulates the lymphatic system, and enhances organ function, contributing to a stronger immune system.
- **Chronic Pain Relief:** Regular yoga practice can be beneficial in managing and alleviating chronic pain conditions, such as arthritis, headaches, and lower back pain.
- **Better Respiratory Health:** Pranayama (breath control exercises) improves lung capacity, boosts oxygen intake, and helps manage conditions like asthma and stress-related breathlessness.

2. Mental Clarity and Emotional Balance

- **Stress Reduction:** Yoga is a proven way to manage and reduce stress. It calms the nervous system through relaxation and mindfulness techniques.
- **Mental Clarity and Focus:** Meditation and mindfulness practices in yoga improve concentration, cognitive function, and clarity of thought.
- **Emotional Regulation:** Yoga fosters emotional balance by teaching self-awareness and promoting a calm, relaxed state of mind.
- **Improved Sleep:** The relaxation techniques and mindful breathing taught in yoga help reduce the mental chatter that interferes with sleep, leading to improved quality of rest.

3. Holistic Health and Well-being

- **Mind-Body Connection:** Yoga nurtures the connection between the mind, body, and spirit. It encourages individuals to pay attention to their body's signals.
- **Holistic Approach:** Yoga emphasizes the integration of a balanced diet, proper breathing, adequate sleep, and emotional well-being.
- **Detoxification:** Certain yoga practices stimulate detoxification of the body by improving digestion, boosting circulation.

4. Spiritual and Personal Growth

- **Self-Awareness and Self-Discovery:** Yoga fosters a deep connection with one's inner self, leading to greater self-awareness and personal growth. It encourages reflection and provides tools for self-discovery.
- **Spiritual Peace:** Yoga's spiritual aspects—such as meditation and mindfulness—help individuals experience a sense of inner peace and a connection with something greater than themselves.
- **Liberation (Moksha):** In traditional yoga philosophy, the ultimate aim is to reach a state of liberation (Moksha).

5. Prevention and Management of Health Conditions

- **Chronic Diseases:** Yoga helps in the management of chronic diseases such as diabetes, hypertension, and heart disease.
- **Mental Health:** Yoga is widely used as a complementary treatment for mental health conditions like anxiety, depression.
- **Better Digestion and Detoxification:** Yoga practices that focus on twisting and stretching can improve digestion and support the detoxification process, promoting a healthier gut.

6. Social and Community Connection

- **Sense of Belonging:** Yoga classes create a sense of community, where individuals can connect, support, and learn from one another.
- **Global Impact:** As yoga spreads worldwide, it connects people across cultures and backgrounds, fostering global unity, health, and peace.

7. Lifestyle and Well-being

- **Promotes a Balanced Lifestyle:** Yoga encourages individuals to live with awareness, balance, and moderation in all aspects of life.
- **Healthy Habits:** Yoga encourages the development of healthy habits such as regular exercise, mindful eating, sufficient rest, and positive thinking.

Importance of Yoga in Today's World:

- **Combatting Modern Lifestyle Challenges:** It counters the effects of sedentary lifestyles, poor posture, stress, and mental health challenges.
- **Accessible to All:** Yoga is adaptable and can be practiced by individuals of all ages and fitness levels.
- **Global Popularity and Acceptance:** With its widespread benefits, yoga has become a global movement for improving physical and mental health.

Asanas and Pranayama : Effect on various systems in human body :

Asanas (yoga postures) and Pranayama (breathing techniques) have profound effects on various systems in the human body.

1. Musculoskeletal System

- **Asanas:**
 - **Strengthening and Toning Muscles:** Regular practice of asanas strengthens and tones muscles throughout the body. For example, poses like **Plank and Warrior** help build core strength and muscle endurance.
 - **Improving Flexibility:** Asanas such as **Forward Fold and Downward Dog** improve flexibility by lengthening muscles and increasing joint range of motion.
 - **Posture Alignment:** Poses like **Mountain Pose and Tree Pose** help improve posture by strengthening the muscles that support the spine and ensuring proper alignment.
 - **Joint Health:** Certain asanas provide gentle movement and stretching for the joints, reducing stiffness and promoting mobility. For example, **Cat-Cow Pose** improves spinal flexibility and helps with back pain relief.
- **Pranayama:**
 - **Enhanced Oxygen Flow:** Proper breath control during pranayama increases the flow of oxygen to muscles and tissues, which aids in muscle recovery and performance.
 - **Relieving Muscle Tension:** **Slow, deep breathing** calms the nervous system, reducing muscle tension, especially in areas like the neck, shoulders, and back.

2. Cardiovascular System

- **Asanas:**
 - **Improving Circulation:** Asanas such as **Downward Dog, Forward Bends,** and **Backbends** enhance blood circulation by improving the flow of oxygenated blood to the heart and extremities.
 - **Lowering Blood Pressure:** Poses like **Legs Up the Wall and Child's Pose** help lower blood pressure by activating the parasympathetic nervous system (relaxation response).
 - **Heart Rate Regulation:** Dynamic sequences like **Sun Salutations** and gentle yoga routines help in maintaining a balanced heart rate, contributing to cardiovascular fitness.
- **Pranayama:**
 - **Stimulating Heart Rate Variability:** Slow, deep breathing techniques like **Ujjayi Pranayama** (victorious breath) and **Anulom Vilom** (alternate nostril breathing) stimulate the parasympathetic nervous system, which can slow the heart rate and promote relaxation.
 - **Reducing Stress and Hypertension:** Breathwork such as **Bhastrika** (bellows breath) and **Kapalbhati** (skull shining breath) can improve circulation and help reduce high blood pressure by relaxing blood vessels and reducing stress.
 - **Enhancing Blood Oxygen Levels:** Pranayama helps in improving the exchange of gases (oxygen and carbon dioxide) in the lungs, thus improving the oxygen levels in the bloodstream.

3. Respiratory System

- **Asanas:**
 - **Lung Expansion:** Certain poses, especially Chest Openers like **Camel Pose** and **Fish Pose**, expand the chest and lungs, increasing lung capacity.
 - **Improved Diaphragm Function:** Poses that involve deep stretching, such as **Cobra Pose** and **Bridge Pose**, help strengthen the diaphragm and improve its ability to control breath.
- **Pranayama:**
 - **Lung Cleansing:** Techniques like **Kapalbhati** (active exhalation) help expel toxins from the lungs and clear the respiratory passages.
 - **Increased Lung Capacity:** Practices such as **Anulom Vilom** (alternate nostril breathing) and **Bhramari** (bee breath) help expand lung capacity by improving control over the inhalation and exhalation process.
 - **Balancing the Breath:** **Ujjayi Pranayama** helps regulate the flow of air and improves oxygen absorption, making the lungs more efficient at gas exchange.

4. Nervous System

- **Asanas:**
 - **Calming the Mind:** Asanas like **Child's Pose**, **Forward Fold**, and **Savasana** trigger relaxation responses by activating the parasympathetic nervous system.
 - **Improving Nervous System Health:** Asanas that involve balance (like **Tree Pose**) and coordination (like **Warrior III**) promote brain-body communication, improving neuroplasticity and coordination.
- **Pranayama:**
 - **Balancing the Autonomic Nervous System:** Pranayama helps balance the autonomic nervous system by calming the sympathetic nervous system .
 - **Reducing Stress and Anxiety:** Breath control practices like **Bhramari** (bee breath) and **Nadi Shodhana** (alternate nostril breathing) help reduce anxiety and calm the mind by lowering cortisol levels.
 - **Improving Focus and Mental Clarity:** Techniques like **Kapalbhati** and **Ujjayi Pranayama** help improve mental clarity, focus, and concentration by activating certain brain areas .

5. Digestive System

- **Asanas:**
 - **Improving Digestion:** Twisting postures such as **Seated Twist** and **Revolved Triangle Pose** help stimulate digestion by massaging the abdominal organs and improving blood circulation to the digestive tract.
 - **Stimulating Peristalsis:** Poses like **Forward Bends (e.g., Paschimottanasana)** and **Downward Dog** help improve peristalsis (the wave-like motion that moves food through the digestive tract) and can aid in alleviating constipation.
 - **Supporting Detoxification:** Certain postures, such as **Viparita Karani (legs up the wall)**, help promote the body's natural detoxification process by improving lymphatic circulation.

- **Pranayama:**
 - **Supporting Digestive Fire (Agni):** Breath techniques like **Kapalbhati (active exhalation)** and **Bhastrika (bellows breath)** stimulate the digestive system by improving circulation to the digestive organs and boosting metabolic rate.
 - **Relieving Digestive Discomfort:** Deep, slow breathing techniques like **Diaphragmatic Breathing** can help calm the digestive tract and reduce issues like bloating, indigestion, or acid reflux.

6. Endocrine System

- **Asanas:**
 - **Regulating Hormones:** Poses like **Shoulder Stand** and **Plow Pose** stimulate the thyroid gland, helping regulate metabolism and energy levels.
 - **Supporting Adrenal Glands:** Asanas like **Cat-Cow Pose** and **Cobra Pose** help relieve tension in the body, reducing the impact of stress on the adrenal glands and balancing cortisol production.
- **Pranayama:**
 - **Balancing Hormones:** Certain pranayama techniques, such as **Kapalbhati** and **Ujjayi**, have a balancing effect on hormones by reducing stress and improving circulation to hormone-producing glands.
 - **Regulating the Menstrual Cycle:** Yoga practices, including specific pranayama and asanas, help reduce stress and promote hormonal balance, which can be beneficial for women in regulating their menstrual cycle.

7. Immune System

- **Asanas:**
 - **Strengthening Immunity:** Regular yoga practice enhances lymphatic flow and detoxification, improving the function of the immune system. Poses like **Downward Dog** and **Chest Openers** increase the drainage of lymph nodes, helping remove toxins.
 - **Reducing Inflammation:** Yoga helps lower inflammatory markers in the body by promoting relaxation and reducing stress.
- **Pranayama:**
 - **Boosting Immune Function:** Pranayama enhances the flow of oxygen and helps cleanse the body of toxins. It boosts white blood cell production and lymphatic function, which strengthens the immune system.
 - **Regulating Inflammatory Responses:** Slow, controlled breathing reduces the body's inflammatory responses and supports immune function.

ASANAS :

“**Asana**” is the Sanskrit word and for a physical posture. Expressed in general terms Asana denotes a specific position which can be held in a relaxed and comfortable manner for a long period of time.

Benefits of Asanas

1. All-round fitness ,
2. Weight loss ,
3. Stress relief ,
4. Inner peace ,
5. Improved immunity ,
6. Living with greater awareness ,
7. Better relationships ,
8. Increased energy ,
9. Better flexibility and posture ,
10. Better intuition

Types of Asanas And Their Benefits:

Kumbhakasana - Plank Pose :



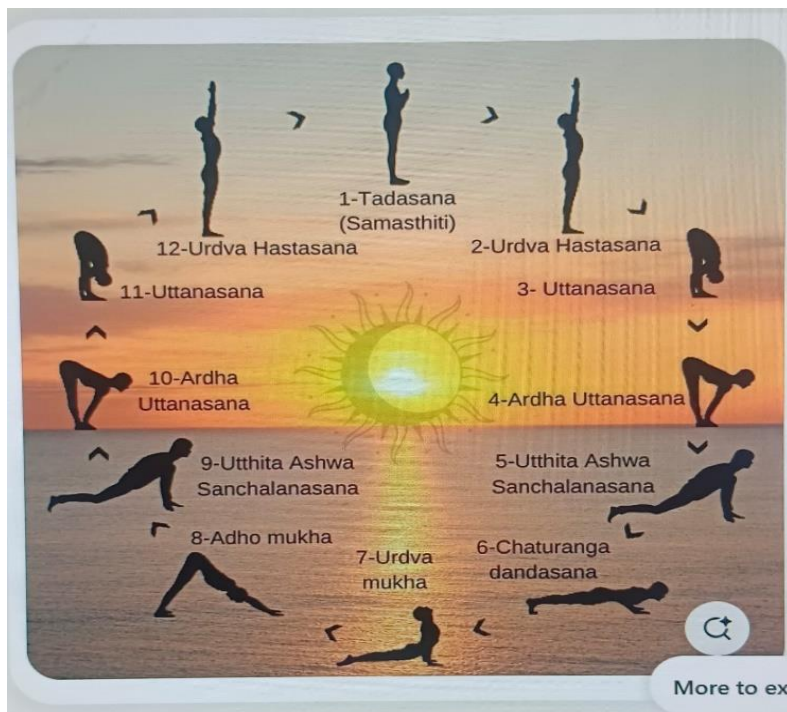
Plank Pose — *Kumbhakasana* is an arm balancing yoga pose that tones the abdominal muscles while strengthening the arms and spine. Its name comes from the Sanskrit words "kumbhak," which means "breath retention," and "asana," which means "pose." Plank is an essential component of Sun Salutations

Benefits of Plank Pose :

Plank Pose tones all of the core muscles of the body, including the abdomen, chest, and low back. It strengthens the arms, wrists, and shoulders.

Sun Salutation, or Surya Namaskar :

Sun Salutation, or *Surya Namaskar*, is a traditional sequence of yoga poses designed to warm up the body, increase flexibility, and connect breath with movement..



1. Tadasana - Mountain Pose :

- Stand tall with your feet together and arms at your sides. Ground down through your feet, engage your legs, lift your chest, and extend your arms upward, palms facing each other.
- Breathe deeply and set your intention for the practice.

2. Urdhva Hastasana - Inhale – Upward Salute :

- Reach your arms overhead as you inhale, palms facing each other or slightly apart. Look up toward your hands, stretching the entire body upward.

3. Uttanasana - Exhale – Forward Fold :

- As you exhale, fold forward, bringing your hands to the floor. Keep a slight bend in your knees if necessary.

4. Ardha Uttanasana -Inhale – Halfway Lift :

- On your inhale, lengthen your spine forward, bringing your chest halfway up. Your hands can be placed on your shins, thighs, or the floor, and your back should be flat with your shoulders drawing away from your ears.

5. Plank Pose - Exhale :

- Exhale and step or jump back into Plank Pose, keeping your body in one straight line from head to heels. Your shoulders should be aligned over your wrists.

6. Chaturanga Dandasana - Inhale – (Low Push-Up):

- Lower down from Plank Pose by bending your elbows, keeping them close to your body. Lower until your upper arms are parallel to the floor (or just above it).

7. Urdhva Mukha Svanasana - Exhale – Upward-Facing Dog :

- Press into your hands as you straighten your arms and lift your chest up, arching your back. The tops of your feet should press into the floor.

8. Adho Mukha Svanasana - Inhale – Downward-Facing Dog :

- Push your hips up and back, forming an upside-down “V” shape with your body. Keep your arms straight, hands pressing into the floor.

9. Ardha Uttanasana - Inhale – Step or Jump Forward :

- Step or jump your feet forward to meet your hands. Lengthen your spine as you come into the Halfway Lift position once again.

10. Uttanasana - Exhale – Forward Fold :

Fold forward again, letting your head and neck relax.

11. Urdhva Hastasana - Inhale – Upward Salute :

Rise up, reaching your arms overhead and lifting your chest as you inhale.

12. Mountain Pose - Tadasana - Exhale :

Lower your arms back down to your sides, returning to the standing position.

Benefits of Sun Salutation:

- **Full-body stretch:** It stretches and strengthens almost every part of the body, including the arms, legs, spine, and core.
- **Increases energy:** The fluid movement and coordinated breathing help energize the body and mind.
- **Improves flexibility and strength:** It helps enhance flexibility, especially in the spine, hips, and hamstrings, while building strength in the arms and core.
- **Calms the mind:** The breath focus and rhythmic movements promote mindfulness and reduce stress.

Virabhadrasana -Yoga warrior poses :

One of the most common groups of asanas in hatha yoga are the Warrior poses, known in Sanskrit as Virabhadrasana. Vira means “hero” and bhadra translates as “blessing,” “auspicious” or “friend.”

There are 5 primary warrior asanas:



Warrior I (Virabhadrasana I) — The front knee is bent and the hips are turned forward with the arms raised.

Benefits of Warrior 1

- Physically, this asana works to strengthen your lower body, especially your feet, ankles, glutes, and quadriceps.
- Mentally, it promotes focus, concentration and body awareness.
- On an emotional level, Warrior I is a fiery pose of bravery, celebration and virtue.

Warrior II (Virabhadrasana II) — The front knee is bent and the hips are turned to the side with the arms parallel.

Benefits of Warrior 2

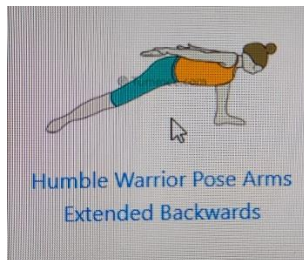
- This asana challenges us to find ease within effort and builds mental stamina, inner strength and concentration.
- With practice, this asana will develop the courage and power to stare down your battles with ease and grace.

Warrior III (Virabhadrasana III) — Balancing on one foot, the standing leg is straight and the opposite leg is lifted with the arms reaching forward.

Benefits of Warrior 3

- This balancing Warrior creates muscular stability as you engage your core and stabilizer muscles, spine, shoulders, hamstrings, calves, and ankles.
- This challenging pose strengthens your focus, concentration, and mindfulness.
- This warrior teaches us how to transform our biggest challenges and struggles into strengths

Humble Warrior (Baddha Virabhadrasana or Virabhadra Mudra) — The legs are the same in Warrior II, but the torso bows forward with the arms clasped behind.



Benefits of Humble Warrior

- The pose tones and strengthens your hamstrings, quadriceps, calves, abdomen, glutes and back while stretching and opening your shoulders, chest, arms and hips.
- On a mental level, it builds body-mind awareness and creates a sense of introspection and groundedness.
- Emotionally, this asana encourages vulnerability, humility, acceptance and a sense of surrender to a higher power.

Reverse Warrior (Viparita Virabhadrasana) — The legs are the same in Warrior II, but the arms and torso reach towards the back straight leg.



Benefits of Reverse Warrior

- This asana deeply stretches the side body, as well as the hips, spine, chest, and inner thighs. It strengthens your abdominals, intercostal muscles, neck, arms.
- This side bending pose is also known as the Peaceful Warrior as it calms your mind by increasing the flow of prana and blood and releases tension in the upper body.
- Emotionally and mentally, Reverse Warrior is a great way to add strength, power, perseverance, self-esteem, and beauty to your daily practice.

Forward Bends for Beginners :

- Child's Pose * Head-to-knee pose * Seated Forward Bend Pose
- Standing Forward Fold * Downward-Facing Dog Pose

Balasana - Child's Pose :



Known as Balasana, the Child's pose is often practiced as a restorative posture. Child's Pose stretches the hips, thighs and ankles. It activates the parasympathetic nervous system, reducing stress and anxiety.

How to practice Child's Pose

- Kneel down on your mat with your knees about hip width apart.
- Now slowly bend forward bringing your forehead on the mat. Your arms should be stretched out in front of the body.
- You can also place a cushion below your forehead.
- Stay here for a few slow deep breaths and then gently come back up.

Janu Sirsasana - Head-to-knee pose :



The forward bend stretches the hamstrings, groin and entire back. It is a one-legged forward bend, known as Janu Sirsasana, that calms the mind, relieves stress and anxiety, reduces fatigue and mild depression.

How to practice Head-to-knee Pose

- Sit with the legs outstretched and the feet together. Bend the left leg, placing the heel of the foot. Keep the left knee on the floor.
- Place the hands on top of the right knee, keeping the spine straight and the back muscles relaxed. Slowly bend forward, sliding the hands down the right leg, and grasp the right foot.
- Make an effort to touch the knee with the forehead. Stay here and keep breathing deeply for a few seconds or as long as comfortable.

Paschimottanasana - Seated Forward Bend Pose:



Known as Paschimottanasana, this forward bend is known to balance the autonomic nervous system. It could be challenging for beginners to practice without bending the knees in the beginning, however, care must be taken to keep the knees straight and bend only as much as possible. The back should be round but should remain straight. Paschimottanasana relieves stress, anxiety and tiredness. It stretches the back, shoulders, hamstrings and quadriceps. It also helps reduce blood pressure.

How to practice Seated Forward Bend Pose

- Sit up with the legs stretched out straight in front of you (Dandasana). Keep the spine straight and toes pointing upwards.
- Inhale, raise both arms above your head and stretch up. Keep the spine erect. Focus on moving forwards towards the toes, rather than down towards the knees.
- Place your hands on your legs, wherever they reach. Do not try to force yourself closer to the thighs if it is difficult.
- Breathe in, keep your head straight and lengthen the spine. As you exhale, gently try to take your naval closer to the knees.

- Release the grip; inhale, raise both the arms up and lift the chin and chest as well
- Breathe out, lower your arms and come back to Dandasana.

Uttanasana -Standing Forward Fold :



Known as Uttanasana, the Standing Forward Fold pose is a part of the Surya Namaskar series. This posture stretches the entire back and legs, including the calf muscles, hamstrings and quadriceps. The posture improves blood circulation to the head. Similar to the Seated Forward Bend, ensure the back remains straight and does not round.

How to practice the Standing Forward Fold

- Stand with your feet hip-width apart and your arms at your sides.
- Raise your hands up and start bending over at your hips until you're placing your palms on your shins, ankles, or the floor (wherever you can reach).
- You can bend your knees a little bit, but try to keep them as straight as you can.
- Let your head hang down and relax, whilst keeping your legs nice and long.
- You can hold the pose for up to a minute or as long as comfortable.

Adho Mukha Svanasana - Downward-Facing Dog Pose :



Adho Mukha Svanasana or downward-facing dog pose lengthens and decompresses the spine, stretches the hamstrings, strengthens your arms, flushes your brain with fresh oxygen and calms your mind.

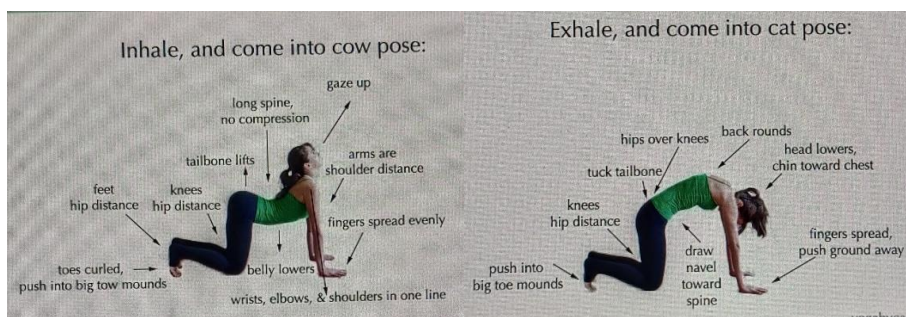
Technique: Lie down on the floor on your stomach and face downward. Place the palms next to the chest. Exhaling, raise your trunk from the floor. Straighten the arms, move the head inward towards the feet and extend the back, trying to press the heels firmly into the ground keeping the knees straight making an inverted 'V' with the body.

Benefits of Adho Mukha Svanasana:

1. It calms the brain.
2. Reduces stiffness in the shoulder region and tones the legs.

Marjaryasana/Bitilasana - Cat Cow Pose :

Cat-Cow Pose, or *Marjaryasana-Bitilasana*, is a dynamic and accessible yoga sequence that involves moving between two positions—Cat Pose and Cow Pose—while coordinating your breath. It's great for warming up the spine, increasing flexibility, and relieving tension in the back and neck.



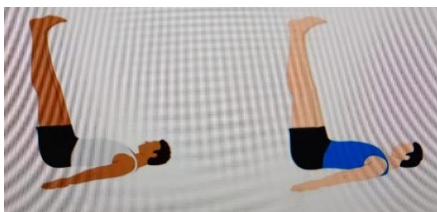
How to do Cat-Cow Pose:

1. Start in Tabletop Position:
 - Begin on your hands and knees, with your wrists aligned directly under your shoulders and your knees directly under your hips. Spread your fingers wide and press your palms into the mat.
2. Move into Cow Pose (Bitilasana):
 - On an inhale, gently drop your belly toward the mat, lifting your chest and tailbone upward. Let your gaze shift slightly upward, creating a slight arch in your back.
3. Move into Cat Pose (Marjaryasana):
 - On the exhale, round your spine upwards toward the ceiling, tucking your chin toward your chest and drawing your belly button in toward your spine. Push the floor away with your hands to deepen the stretch.
4. Flow Between Cat and Cow:
 - Continue moving between the two poses with your breath, inhaling as you move into Cow Pose and exhaling as you move into Cat Pose.

Benefits of Cat-Cow Pose:

- Improves spinal flexibility: The flow helps to gently stretch and mobilize the spine.
- Relieves tension: It's especially helpful for releasing tightness in the back, neck, and shoulders.
- Stimulates abdominal organs: The movement encourages circulation to the digestive organs and helps with digestion.
- Promotes mindful breathing: The breath-coordinated movement enhances body awareness and calms the mind.

Viparita Karani - "Legs Up the Wall" pose :



Viparita Karani, also known as "Legs Up the Wall" pose, is a restorative yoga posture that involves lying on your back and placing your legs up against a wall while keeping your body relaxed. It's a gentle inversion pose, and it offers many benefits, including:

- **Improving circulation:** By elevating your legs, you help blood flow back toward the heart, which can reduce swelling and improve circulation in the legs.
- **Relieving stress and tension:** It helps calm the nervous system and can promote a sense of relaxation, making it great for stress relief.
- **Alleviating lower back and leg pain:** The pose helps release tension in the lower back and provides relief for tired or achy legs.
- **Improving lymphatic drainage:** The position supports lymph flow, which can aid in detoxification.

How to practice Viparita Karani:

1. Sit close to a wall, then gently lie back onto the floor.

2. Swing your legs up the wall, keeping your legs straight and your feet flexed.
3. Your arms can rest on the floor beside you, palms up, or you can place a cushion under your hips for added support.
4. Stay in the pose for 5-15 minutes, breathing deeply and allowing your body to relax.

Sukhasana Or Easy Pose :



This is an amazing one for beginners as it gives one the desired comfort. The *asana* is beyond the horizons of the physical dimension and gives a spiritual bliss.

Tip: Sit with the legs tucked inside the opposite thighs and the spine should be vertically straight. The hands should be placed on the knees and breathe in and out gently.

1. It helps to reduce anxiety, stress and mental tiredness.
2. It corrects the body posture and stretches the chest and spine.

Naukasana Or Boat Pose :



This is one of the easy asanas. This *asana* stretches the abdominal muscles and it improves digestion and reduces belly fat. It is good to improve the efficiency of abdominal muscles.

Naukasana is seated asana that requires core strength to the body in “V” shape

Tip: One needs to lie on one's back with legs together and the hands-on the thighs, without touching them. Then the body should make a 30-degree angle.

Dhanurasana Or Bow Pose :



This asana stretches the entire body. It helps in weight loss, boosts digestion and blood circulation. It is a very effective yoga pose for making the back flexible.

Technique: Lie down on the ground on your belly. Bend the knees backwards. Hold the feet with hands below the ankles. Take a deep breath and raise the chest as high as possible. Now stretch the feet, so that your body takes the shape of a bow. Stay in this position as long as you can. While breathing out, relax the body and come in the initial position. Repeat this Aasan 3-4 times.

Benefits of Dhanur Asana:

1. It makes the spine flexible and reduces its stiffness.
2. Reduces obesity.

3. It can cure stomach pains.
4. Strengthens the muscles of the arms, legs and stomach.
5. It increases the lung power and breathing process.

Vakrasana Or Twisted Pose :



Vakrasana makes the body flexible and reduces belly fat and also helps in improving digestion by regulating digestive juices. Vakrasana is a simple seated position that offers a soft spinal twist while also serving as a warm-up for more vigorous twisting postures .

Vakrasana comes under the category of seated asanas. Here, the upper body is twisted to bring the upper spine parallel to the sides of the yoga mat. Twisted pose benefits our lower and middle back, hips and neck.

Technique: *Make a posture like a steady stance by placing the right foot high up on the left thigh and the hands should be over the head with the palms together. The spine must be straight and the sole of the foot flat and firm. After releasing the pose, one needs to change the position and try the other leg.*

Benefits of Vakrasana:

1. Tones the muscles of the back and thus brings stability to the spine
2. Straightens the upper back
3. Strengthens the neck muscles
4. Helps in reducing belly fat
5. Improves digestion by regulating digestive juices.

Kakasana Or Crow Pose



For anyone who wants to improve their concentration power, wipe out sluggishness and enhance mental and physical balance, *kakasana* is the best option, as it stretches the muscles of arms, wrists, and forearms. **The posture makes the body and mind feel light. It brings together the scattered mind.** It is difficult to perform and takes a lot of practices. **Tip:** *One needs to squat and keep the legs slightly apart with the hands firmly on the floor. After that, the body should be uplifted and the hands on the floor.*

Bhujangasana Or Cobra Stretch



Bhujangasana is known as the corrector of the curvature and makes the spine flexible. The curve structure of the asana massages the deep back muscles, spine and nerves. It can be a great asana for people dealing with arthritis of the lower back and lower back pains.

Technique: It is also called 'Sarapa Asan'. To do this Asana lie down on the ground on your stomach, keeping the hands close to your shoulders, raise the chest to such a level that the arms get straight this will be done while stretching the legs. Take the toes in and hang the head slowly behind. Slowly come in the initial position and repeat this 3-5 times.

Benefits of Bhujangasana:

1. It makes the spine flexible and broadens the chest.
2. Makes the neck, shoulders, chest and head more active.
3. Increase blood circulation.
4. Gives power and flexibility to the body.
5. It reduces obesity.
6. Helpful in strengthening the digestive system and increasing the lung power

Halasana Or Plough Pose



The *halasana* opens up the spinal disc and aims to keep the spinal system youthful as it stretches the spinal muscles. The stretch releases the tension from the shoulders, **arms and spine**. **It is one of the best asanas to tackle obesity. By revitalising the internal organs, it can cure indigestion and constipation and neck arthritis stiffness.**

Halasana is a folded inversion, begin, and lie down on the ground with arms at the sides and palms pressing down (According to Yogapedia).

1. Helpful in strengthening the neck muscles.
2. Helpful in reducing weight and back pain.
3. Strengthens the backbone
4. Improves blood circulation.

Sarvangasana Or Shoulder Stand



The meaning of *Sarvangasana* is “all parts”. The *asana* involves the entire body and revitalises it. It involves the thyroid gland and stimulates metabolism, protein synthesis, and blood circulation. The posture of the **asana strengthens muscles** and lowers the chances of kidney and bone disease. **It aims to reduce insomnia, depression and mental anxiety.**
Tip: As the name suggests, one needs to stand on the shoulder.

Shirsasana Or Headstand



Sirsasana aka “the king of the asanas” is one of the most difficult asanas but has remarkable benefits. The asana involves the brain, spine and entire nervous system and stimulates the pituitary and pineal glands. The upside-down pose helps to ease constipation and relieves nervous disorders and anxiety.

Technique: *Take the support of a wall, to begin with. Keep the spine straight with your head down and feet up. Use your hands to support yourself.*

Benefits of Sirsasana:

1. It helps in improving blood circulation.
2. Gives strength to the respiratory system.
3. It improves concentration and memory.

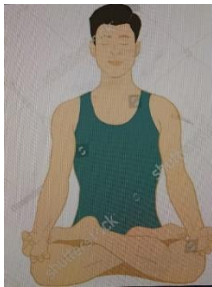
Gomukhasana or Cow Face Pose



It is one of the basic *asanas* that opens up the hips. As the *asana* stretches the hips, arms, thighs and back, **it helps in muscle relaxation.**

Tip: *One needs to slide the knees together then the right leg should be over the left leg with the right foot going under the left buttock.*

Padmasana, or Lotus Pose :



Padmasana, or Lotus Pose, is a seated yoga posture known for its grounding and meditative qualities. It is a classic pose often associated with meditation and spiritual practices, as it helps to calm the mind and open up energy channels within the body. The pose involves sitting cross-legged with each foot placed on the opposite thigh, creating a symmetrical and stable foundation for stillness.

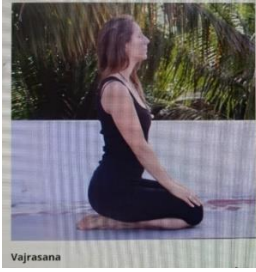
How to do Padmasana (Lotus Pose):

Sit on the Floor , Bend Your Right Knee , Bend Your Left Knee, Position Your Hands , Sit Tall , Stay in the Pose:

Benefits of Padmasana:

- Promotes Flexibility , Improves Posture , Calms the Mind, Stimulates Energy Flow , Improves Circulation

Vajrasana



Vajrasana the ‘thunderbolt’ pose; a kneeling posture with buttocks resting upon the heels (According to Wikipeddia).

How to do Vajrasana (Thunderbolt Pose):

Start in a Kneeling Position , Sit on Your Heels, Position Your Hands, Align Your Body, Breathe Deeply

Benefits of Vajrasana:

- Improves Posture , Promotes Digestion ,Calms the Mind, Relieves Tension, Improves Circulation.

Tadasana



Tadasana is the starting and finishing position of all sun salutation sequences in addition to its use as a resting pose between other more strenuous postures (According to yogapedia).

It is a basic standing pose. It teaches you the art of standing correctly and increases your awareness of your body.

Technique: Stand with your heels and toes joined and raise the arms up, the knees can also be left open according to the width of your shoulders. Palm should be upward and eyes should be looking straight. Take a breath in. Then raise the heels and lay your weight on the toes. Pull the body up and after some time take the body down while breathing out. Repeat it 10 to 15 times.

Benefits of Tadasana:

1. Helpful in strengthening the leg muscles.
2. Helps in increasing the height of the children.
3. Helpful in removing leg pain.
4. It corrects bad posture and improves the alignment of your body.

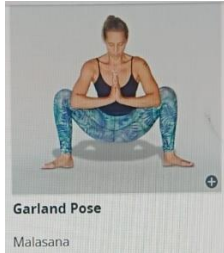
Makarasana

Makarasana is however often used as a relaxation asana, an alternative to the supine savasana, and both head and legs are rested on the floor (According to Wikipedia).



MAKARASANA
CROCODILE POSE

Malasana or Yoga Squat Pose:



Garland Pose
Malasana

Malasana has a grounding quality—it taps into downward-flowing energy known in yoga as apana vayu—and is a good pose to practice whenever you need to bring on calm.

Technique: You can enter Malasana by standing with feet parallel, slightly wider than the hips. Then bend knees and slowly lower down the pelvis until the hips go lower than the knees. Keep the back straight and take arms in front in a prayer position.

Benefits of Malasana:

1. Strengthens the Lower Back
2. Helps in stretching the groin and also the lower back.
3. Tones the belly.
4. Releases tension in the hips and knees.

Bandha - Bridge



The Bridge yoga pose is a great front hip joints opener, it also strengthens your spine, opens the chest, and improves your spinal flexibility in addition to stimulating your thyroid. This pose brings many benefits to your body, such as the relief from stress, anxiety, insomnia and it can help with depression.

Trikonasana - Triangle



The Triangle is one of those postures that brings to your body many benefits. For example, it improves the flexibility of your spine; it helps with the alignment of your shoulders; it relieves back pain and stiffness in the neck area, but don't forget you need to practice each posture on the left and right side – balancing your postures is very important. With the practice of this posture you will notice many improvements, but especially for your posture.

Utkatasana - Chair



The Chair yoga position tones your leg muscles, strengthens your hip flexors, ankles, calves and back. It stretches the chest and shoulders. It reduces symptoms of flat feet and it stimulates your heart, diaphragm, and abdominal organs.

Vriksasana - Tree



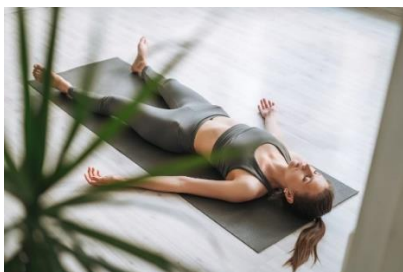
The Tree yoga pose may seem as another easy posture but it is not a resting asana. Your back should be aligned properly (extended), your hips should be at one level, and since your stability depends on the distribution of your weight on your standing leg ensure you do while maintaining and improving your balance.

Natarajasana - King Dancer



The King Dancer yoga pose strengthens your legs, improves balance and core strength while also stretches your shoulders and improves your focus. It is one of the most graceful asana.

Savasana - Corpse



The Savasana or Corpse yoga pose is one of the most important postures. It is meant to rejuvenate your mind and body after practice while also allowing you to shift your attention to your inner-self.

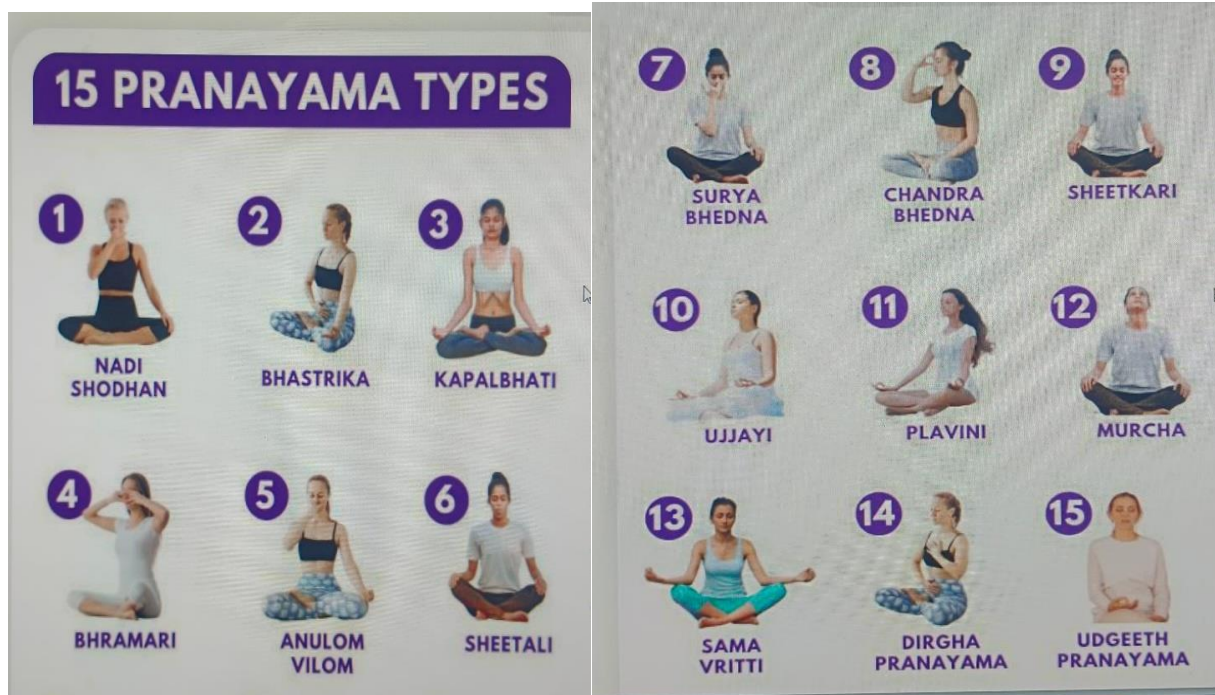
Technique: Lie down on the floor like a corpse – completely relaxed and on your back. Keep your legs apart and hands away from your body with the palms facing upwards. Shut your eyes and concentrate on relaxing each and every muscle in your body.

Benefits of Savasana:

1. Savasana cures hypertension and mental stress.
2. It refreshes the mind and body.
3. It removes the fatigue.

Pranayama :

Pranayama technique of the breathing and breath control which regulates energy flow and aims at maintaining energy balance



Types of Pranayama :

Nadi Sodhana Pranayama :

Alternate Nostril breathing is known as Nadi Shodana Pranayama. Nadi is a Sanskrit word meaning 'Channel' or 'Flow' and Shodhana means 'Purification'. Simply, Nadi Shodhana practice is performed to purify the energy channels of the mind-body.

How to do it?

Nadi Shodhan is practised on an empty stomach preferably in the early morning. To begin with, choose a comfortable sitting posture with your spine straight and shoulders rolled back and down. Bring your head, neck, and spine in one line and begin by focusing on your breath.

Fold the Index and middle finger inwards towards the right-hand thumb while the other two rest together in Vishnu Mudra. With your right thumb, you can close the right nostril when you inhale from the left while exhaling from the right close the left nostril with the index and middle finger.

Benefits :

- Increases the amount of Oxygen within the body
- Purifies the body by excreting toxins
- Helps to rejuvenate the Nervous System
- It helps to balance hormones
- Improves the function of the respiratory system
- Helps to balance the masculine and feminine energies within the body
- Promotes mental clarity and cognitive function
- It brings balance to the right and left hemispheres of the brain

Bhastrika Pranayama

The term 'Bhastrika' is derived from the Sanskrit word 'Bhastri', which means 'bellows'. It is an instrument that blacksmiths use to fan the flame in their furnaces. This gives us a clue about the nature of this practice.

How to Do Bhastrika Pranayama

- Find a comfortable position, either cross-legged on the floor or sitting upright in a chair with a straight spine.
- Take a moment to relax and calm your mind before starting.
- Breathe deeply and forcefully through both nostrils, expanding your abdomen and chest.
- Breathe out forcefully through both nostrils, contracting your abdomen to push out the air.
- Maintain a steady rhythm of rapid inhalations and exhalations.
- Start with a short duration, gradually increasing as you get used to the exercise.
- Gradually slow your breathing and return to normal

Benefits of Bhastrika Pranayama :

1. Managing Anxiety
2. Reducing Blood Pressure
3. Heart Health
4. Control Blood Sugar Levels
5. Managing Weight
6. Improve Lung Function
7. Asthma
8. Improve Static Balance
9. Allergic Rhinitis

Kapalabhati Pranayama :

Kapalabhati Pranayama , also known as Skull Shining Breath, is an energizing breathing practice that clears the lungs, the nasal passages, and the mind. In Sanskrit, *Kapal* means “cranium” or “forehead” and *bhati* means “light,” “perception,” and “knowledge.”

How to Practice

Kapalabhati (as with most *pranayamas*) should be practiced on an empty stomach, so allow at least three to four hours after a meal before engaging this pranayama. Choose a comfortable sitting position.

Gently close the eyes and breathe through the nose (you will be breathing through the nostrils throughout this practice).

When you are ready to start practicing *kapalabhati*, expel the breath forcefully through the nostrils (without strain or tension) and simultaneously pull the navel dynamically inward toward the spine, gently contracting the abdominal muscles.

Benefits of Kapalabhati Pranayama

- Balances excess vata , pitta , and kapha
- Cleanses the lungs
- Improves circulation, particularly in the head
- Eliminates mental distractions and invites alertness
- Removes sleepiness, energizing the body and brain
- Sharpens sensory perception

- Bolsters memory, concentration, and intelligence
- Prepares the mind for mental work and meditation
- Keeps the forehead cool
- Tones the digestive organs, improving agni and appetite
- Cleanses the blood
- Stimulates synovial circulation in the joints
- Balances and strengthens the nervous system
- Supports immunity
- Purifies the pranic channels (*srotamsi*) without creating heat.
- Enhances the melodious qualities of the voice

Bhramari Pranayama (Humming Bee Breathing)

The *Bhramari pranayama breathing technique* derives its name from the black Indian bee called Bhramari. *Bhramari pranayama* is effective in instantly calming down the mind. It is one of the best breathing exercises to free the mind of agitation, frustration or anxiety and get rid of anger to a great extent. A simple technique, it can be practiced anywhere – at work or home and is an instant option to de-stress yourself.

The exhalation in this pranayama resembles the typical humming sound of a bee, which explains why it is named so.

How to do Bhramari pranayama

1. Sit up straight in a quiet, well-ventilated corner with your eyes closed. Keep a gentle smile on your face.
2. Keep your eyes closed for some time. Observe the sensations in the body and the quietness within.
3. Place your index fingers on your ears. There is a cartilage between your cheek and ear. Place your index fingers on the cartilage.
4. Take a deep breath in and as you breathe out, gently press the cartilage. You can keep the cartilage pressed or press it in and out with your fingers while making a loud humming sound like a bee.
5. You can also make a low-pitched sound but it is a good idea to make a high-pitched one for better results.
6. Breathe in again and continue the same pattern 3-4 times.

Benefits of Bhramari pranayama

- Gives instant relief from tension, anger and anxiety. It is a very effective breathing technique for people suffering from hypertension as it calms down the agitated mind.
- Gives relief if you're feeling hot or have a slight headache
- Helps mitigate migraines.
- Improves concentration and memory
- Builds confidence.
- Reduces blood pressure.

- Helps calm the mind in preparation for meditation.

Anulom Vilom Prnayama :

There are many different kinds of yoga practice dedicated to breathing, perhaps the most common of pranayama exercises is anulom vilom. Sometimes it is referred to as alternate nostril breathing. To do it, you simply use your finger to restrict your breathing in one nostril and then breathe in and out with the non-restricted nostril.

You alternate which nostril you are restricting, breathing in one side at a time. You then restrict the other nostril and breathe in on the opposite side.

Benefits

In a survey of 44 studies, anulom vilom was found to have a positive effect on:

- The autonomic nervous system
- The cardiopulmonary system (heart and lungs)
- Cognitive (mental) functioning
- Problem-solving
- Motor memory retention
- The respiratory system
- The circulatory system
- Treating bronchial asthma
- Diabetes treatment
- Pain management
- Tuberculosis, an infection that attacks your lungs

Sheetali Pranayam | Cooling Breath :

The meaning of word “Sheetali” is cooling down, that process which can cool down our body and gives feeling of coldness. The word Shitali is originally taken from the word “Sheetal” which means cold or soothing. The daily practice of Sheetali Pranayama can calm the mind along with body.

The process of Sheetali Pranayama is very similar to Sheetkari pranayama. Sheetali Pranayama and Sheetkari is also a breathing technique (Pranayama). The basic purpose of the Shitali Pranayama is to decrease or cool down the body temperature.

Procedure of sheetali pranayam

- Sit comfortably in any meditative pose like Padmasana, Swastikasana e.t.c.
- Keep your both hands on knees.
- Now bring your tongue all the way out and fold both sides of tongue like a tube or straw.
- Take a long, deep inhalation through the tube in the tongue which is formed by folding the both sides of tongue.
- After Inhalation close your mouth and exhale with both nostrils.
- Repeat this about 8 to 10 times.

Benefits of sheetali pranayam

- Sheetali Pranayama is useful in diseases which related to tongue, mouth and throat.
- It is very beneficial in diseases of spleen.
- Helpful in fever and indigestion.
- Controls the High B.P.
- Useful in Pitta related diseases.
- It purifies the blood.
- Best for cooling down the body temperature.
- Best for fighting against the Insomnia problem.
- It calms the mind, and it's a effective stress buster.
- If our mind is calm we can easily deal with anger and anxiety.
- Effective in hyperacidity. ↑

Sheetkari pranayama :

Sheetkari Pranayama, also known as the “hissing breath” is a lesser-known but highly effective yogic breathing technique that offers profound cooling and calming effects. The name “Sheetkari” comes from the Sanskrit word “Sheet,” meaning “cool,” and “Kari,” meaning “that which produces,” indicating its primary function of cooling the body and mind.

Steps to Practice Sheetkari Pranayama

- Sit in a comfortable position with your spine straight. You can sit in a cross-legged position on the floor or on a chair with your feet flat on the ground. Close your eyes and relax your entire body.
- Take a few moments to relax your body and mind. Close your eyes, and take a few deep breaths through your nose to prepare yourself for the practice.
- Open your mouth slightly and clench your teeth together. Inhale slowly and deeply through the gaps in your teeth, producing a hissing sound. As you draw in the air, focus on the cool sensation of the breath entering your body.
- After inhaling, close your mouth and hold the breath for a few seconds if comfortable. This allows the cool air to circulate within your body.
- Exhale slowly and completely through your nose, releasing any tension or heat from your body.
- Continue this process for 5 to 10 rounds, or as long as you feel comfortable. As you practice, keep your mind focused on the cooling and calming effects of the breath.

Benefits of Sheetkari Pranayama (Hissing Breath)

- The primary benefit of Sheetkari Pranayama is its ability to reduce body heat, making it ideal for hot climates or after intense physical activity.
- This pranayama helps to calm the nervous system, reducing stress, anxiety, and mental agitation.
- By activating the parasympathetic nervous system, Sheetkari Pranayama can help lower high blood pressure and heart rate.

- The focus required to produce the hissing sound helps improve concentration and mental clarity.
- The cooling effect on the body can help balance digestive processes, particularly in reducing excess bile and acidity.

Surya Bhedana Pranayama :

Surya Bhedana pranayama in yoga help to generate bodily heat besides alleviating bodily stiffness common during the winter months.

Surya Bhedana is a breathing technique that energizes the Sun energy channel or the Pingala Nadi.

How to perform the Surya Bhedana pranayama : Step-by-step instructions

Step 1: Before you begin breathing, empty your lungs of all the air with the help of a deep exhale.

Step 2 : Inhale through your right nostril

Step 3 : Retain the internal breath , Hold your breath until you are comfortable.

Step 4 : Exhale through your left nostril

Step 5 : Repeat the cycle for as long as comfortable

Surya Bhedana pranayama benefits

1. May enhance physical performance
2. Improved Cardiovascular Health
3. Activates the sympathetic nervous system
4. Clears Sinuses
5. Aids Weight Loss
6. Balances Vata Dosha
7. Awakens Kundalini
8. Helps digestion
9. Purifies blood
10. Ideal for winters
11. Energizes the body
12. Enhances mental alertness
13. Cures respiratory problems
14. Treats sexual problems in women
15. Possibly treat skin-related conditions
16. Reduces phlegm in the body
17. Activates the Pingala Nadi

Chandra Bhedana Pranayama :

Chandra Bhedana Pranayama is one of the lesser known yogic breathing techniques in which you inhale through one nostril only, and out through the opposite nostril. Chandra refers to the moon, or 'tha' syllable in Hatha, which represents a cooling and calm energy. Bhedana means 'piercing', and this is why Chandra Bhedana is also known as the moon piercing breath.

How to practice Chandra Bhedana Pranayama

1. Sit comfortably on the mat in any cross legged position.
2. Bring the right hand in Vishnu Mudra (index finger and middle finger bent towards the palm), and use the thumb to close the right nostril.
3. Inhale deeply through the left nostril and fill the lungs completely.
4. Engage the Jalandhara Bandha (chin lock) and Mula Bandha (root lock).
5. Retain the breath for as long as feels comfortable. In yogic texts, it is said that one should hold the breath until perspiration appears. However, listen carefully to your body, and never overdo it.
6. Release the Jalandhara Bandha (chin lock) and Mula Bandha (root lock), and exhale through the right nostril (Pingala Nadi), keeping the left nostril closed.
7. Continue in this manner for 5-10 rounds, or 1-3 minutes. Advanced practitioners can continue up to 80 rounds per sitting.

Benefits of Chandra Bhedana Pranayama

1. Reduces heat in the body
2. Relieves heartburn
3. Refreshes and energises the mind and body
4. Reduces high blood pressure
5. Reduces fever
6. Decreases the flow of bile from the gallbladder
7. Reduces tension, stress and other mental burdens
8. Daily practice can help to steady the mind

Ujjayi Breathing Pranayama :

“Ujjayi breathing, also known as the victorious breath or ocean breath, encourages deep abdominal breaths instead of the shallow breathing common to most individuals,” Ujjayi breathing has a distinct oceanic sound. “It is a deep diaphragmatic breath in and out through the nose with the back of the throat .

How to Practice Ujjayi Breathing

Try ujjayi breathing on your own by following these pointers from Kristin:

1. Inhale through your nose and exhale through your mouth, restricting the back of your throat and creating a “ha” sound on the exhale. (You can imagine that you’re fogging up a window with your exhale.)
2. Create the same “ha” sound on the next exhale, but now breathe through your nose and keep your mouth closed throughout.
3. Maintain full and even inhales and exhales throughout your yoga or meditation practice.

Benefits of Ujjayi Breathing

Deep breathing exercises such as ujjayi help the mind and body shift from stress to relaxation mode

1. Enhances Your Yoga and Meditation Practices
2. Improves Mood and Mental Health

3. Promotes Cardiovascular Health

4. Bolsters Lung Health

5. Supports Gut Health

Plavini Pranayama :

The name “Plavini” comes from the Sanskrit word “Floating.” Pranayama means Breathing practice. Advanced yoga practitioners perform this Practice to feel lightness in their bodies.

In this Pranayama, practitioners must perform deep and controlled breathing. This means one has to perform a deep inhalation, hold it for a few seconds, and then exhale. This is for relaxation and lightheadedness.

How to Perform Plavini Pranayama?

First, find a quiet and comfortable place and sit with your legs crossed in the lotus position. Keep your back straight and start deep breathing. Make sure to fill your lungs as much as possible and hold your breath for a few seconds.

Benefits of Plavini Pranayama

1 – Improved Lung Capacity

2 – Reduced Stress

3 – Improved Digestion

4 – Improved Focus

Murcha Pranayama :

Murcha Pranayama is an advanced breathing technique, that you need to do with certain mudras and bandhas. It is often called Antara Kumbhaka.

How To Do Murcha Pranayama?

- You have to sit in any cross-legged posture, like Padmasana or Sukhasana.
- Relax the whole body, and keep the hands resting on the knees. The spine should be straight.
- The shoulders should also be held back, with the head and spine in one straight line.
- You have to breathe deeply and slowly, at this stage.
- In the next stage, you have to observe Khechari Mudra, and then start slowly inhaling through the nostrils.
- Bend your head backwards a little, and perform Ujjayi Breath.
- Also do Shambhavi Mudra, if you are comfortable doing it.
- You have to keep the arms straight, and lock them at the elbows.
- Throughout the entire inhalation process, you have to retain the breath.
- Then bring the head down, and lock the chin inside the chest cavity.
- When you become dizzy, you can start exhaling.

Benefits of Murcha Pranayama

- One of the first and foremost benefit of this Pranayama is mental peace.
- Your mental efficiency also increases, if you continue to practice this breathing technique on a regular basis.
- Your mind will also get cleared of any negative emotions, with time. It raises the amount of Prana, passing through the nadis called Ida, Pingala, and Sushumna.
- It also has the power to reduce blood pressure.
- It can also cure muscle weakness.
- It is a precursor to meditation.

Samavritti Pranayama = Equal movement

The purpose of this Pranayama exercise is to equalize the four components of the breath:

Inhalation (puraka)

Internal retention (antara-khumbaka)

Exhalation (rechaka)

External retention (bahya-khumbaka)

The benefits include:

- Refining the breath and awareness of prana flow.
- Calming the body
- Focusing the mind helping to remove distractions making it easier to concentrate and meditate.

How to practise Samavritti

Find a comfortable sitting position – the posture should allow your spine to be upright so you can use a block or cushion to sit on, or a chair. Rest the back of your hands on your legs, palms up with the tips of the index finger and thumb touching (Jnana Mudra).

- Begin with an exhale for the count of four
- Hold on the exhale for the count of four
- Inhale for the count of four
- Hold on the inhale for the count of four

After a few rounds you could take the count up to 6, but you can stay at 4 or if you find you are struggling with the breath simply lower it to 2 or 3 until it feels easier.

After several rounds sit and observe how your body and mind taking Savasana.

Dirgha pranayama :

Dirga is a Sanskrit word where Dirga denotes deep, complete and slow. Once you fill-up the lungs with ample air, the breath is released gradually and uniformly from all these three areas of the body.

How to perform Dirgha pranayama?

- To begin with, sit in padmasana (lotus pose) or lie down in Savasana (corpse pose). If you decide to lie down in Savasana, keep your eyes closed while you relax your face and body. You can either outstretch your legs or bend your knees as per your comfort level.
- Inhale deeply and fill up your stomach with air as much as you can hold.

- Exhale gradually as you expel all the air from your belly.
- Repeat this five times.

The Benefits of Dirgha pranayama

1. Calms down the nervous system
2. Calms down the mind
3. Promotes circulation
4. Improved lung function
5. Improved digestion
6. Promotes restful sleep
7. Fosters meaningful meditation practice
8. Parting thoughts

Udgeeth Pranayam | OM Chanting

The Udgeeth Pranayama is most easy and common pranayama. It is the art of conscious breathing. Udgeeth Pranayama is good to cure depression, insomnia, lack of concentration and other brain related problems. Udgeeth Pranayama involves chanting of AUM (OM) with every exhalation – lasting upto twenty seconds.

Procedure of udgeeth pranayam

- Sit on the Padmasana and Close your eyes, Your spine should be straight.
- Breathe deeply through your nose till diaphragm is full with air, and exhale.
- While exhaling chant the word Om.
- Make sure to keep the sound of “O” long and the “M” short (OOOOOOOm). Udgeeth Pranayama is very simplest pranayama among to all pranayama. Repeat this 3 to five (or 5 minutes if you have time). ↑

Benefits of udgeeth pranayam

- It calms the mind and brings stability.
- It also relieves tension, anger and anxiety.
- It is the Excellent breathing exercises for meditation.
- Effective against hypertension.
- It cures problems related to sleep (Insomnia) and bad dreams.
- Control the high blood pressure and cure it.
- Cures the problems related to the nervous system.
- It Improve memory power. ↑